invested in seeing how we are shaping and scaling this up." Betting big on this universe, YRF is reportedly developing a sequel to *War* with *RRR*'s (2022) Jr NTR joining Hrithik Roshan and planning to bring Pathaan and Tiger together to produce what is expected to be the most expensive Hindi film. But before that, Pathaan may return Tiger's favour with what will likely be a whistle-worthy appearance in the Diwali release, *Tiger 3*.

So, why is Bollywood going the way Marvel did with its superheroes, and Disney with *Star Wars*, with spinoffs and familiar characters from existing worlds? "From a business perspective, it is about connectivity and relatability," says Dinesh Vijan, who heads Maddock Films, creators of the horror comedy universe of films, which includes *Stree* (2018) and *Bhediya* (2022). "The biggest thing a universe does is it makes you feel a part of it. You are inclined to go to the theatre to see the film." Building this universe is an expensive proposition, but the gains are correspondingly higher. It also created a fan base, while the sense of familiarity makes it easy to market and promote the films.

YRF's spy films and Maddock's horror comedies are not the only franchises in the Bollywood multiverse. Filmmaker Rohit Shetty has been milking the cop universe for over a decade now, beginning with Ajay Devgn's *Singham* (2011). In recent





1. *Pathaan* (2023)

2. *Ek Tha Tiger* (2012), *Tiger Zinda Hai* (2017)

3. *War* (2019)

Coming up: *Tiger 3* (2023)

HORROR COMEDY UNIVERSE

CREATORS Maddock Films







1. *Bhediya* (2022)

2. *Stree* (2018)

3. *Roohi* (2021)

Coming up: *Sequels to Stree (2024) and Bhediya (2025)*